

member will have a PDD, which is nothing short of a wearable (and perhaps flexible) laptop-cum-cell phone-cum-PDA that can use your house network or public networks outside for its computing needs. It will act as a complete personal communications device that will make and receive phone calls, send and receive e-mail and other communication from your family, friends, colleagues, and the authorities.

The house CPU will synchronise itself with your PDD to make sure that both are up-to-date all the time—taking care of all data changes that have occurred when you were out.

The Car/Garage

Currently, our cars are the dumbest of the gadgets we interface with, and hopefully, manufacturers will bring some of the technological sophistication that already exists in luxury sedans into the models for the masses.

Even currently available technology can make our cars a million times smarter than they are today, and hopefully this segment will be less ignored in the future—especially as traffic congestion increases, in turn increasing the time we spend inside our cars.

Global Positioning Systems (GPS) are already available in more expensive cars, so imagining this in every car is hardly far-fetched. This will enable your house CPU to connect to the central traffic server, using your predefined authentication, and inform your family of your whereabouts. It will also let your family contact you on your car's communications system.

The car will also have a computer running some very basic functions, such as fuel injection and communications, and could also be set to govern safety—keeping safe distance from other vehicles and objects by using radar or imaging. This could put an end to accidents, traffic congestion and rash driving.

The car's communications device could be a mini-home theatre system, offering both audio and video outputs for video conferencing, phone calls, music or even movies—hopefully the auto-drive functions will be well developed by then.

Your PDD could interface with your car, telling it where your next appointment is, and pinpoint your destination to the car's GPS device. Satellite imagery could help your car automatically chart the fastest route to your destination, taking into consideration traffic and weather conditions.

The car locking system and ignition could be fingerprint-controlled, doing away with the entire “Now where are my car keys?” scenario. It would also help the car identify the driver, adjust the seat accordingly, as well as select the appropriate music playlist and user account. This will ensure that you always hear the music you like, or prevent you from receiving e-mails meant for your dad, or worse, him receiving “I love you” messages from your significant other!

The Gadgets

We understand why many people reading this article might make incredulous sounds, and call it all mumbo jumbo. Well, here are a few gadgets that have already been developed, or prototyped, and are expected to be available to consumers soon...

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